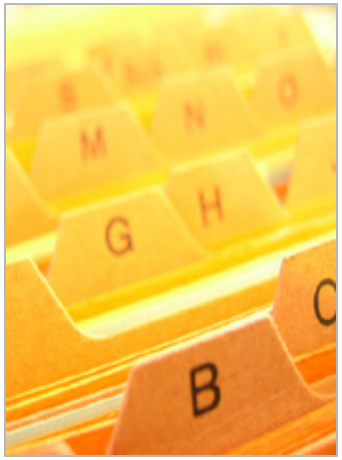
slovak archive of social data

SASD

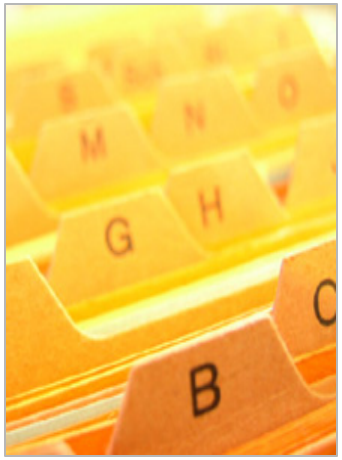
slovenský
archív
sociálnych
dát



Slovak Archive of Social Data "SASD" and DDI 3

IASSIST/IFDO Conference, Tampere, 28.5.2009

Juraj Švec, SASD, juro2000@gmail.com



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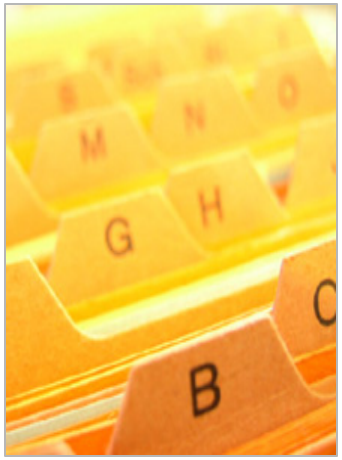

Dark ages and enlightenment in the Slovak data environment

- Missing tradition of archiving and systematic data cataloguing from sociological research in Slovakia
  - (meta)data were lost or
  - stored in individual researcher's drawers or
  - stored (or not) in the Czech republic, many datasets related to Slovakia from the Czechoslovak period were administered by agencies located in the Czech republic
- Unsuccessful project at Slovak Academy of Sciences in 2002
- Slovak Archive of Social Data established in 2004

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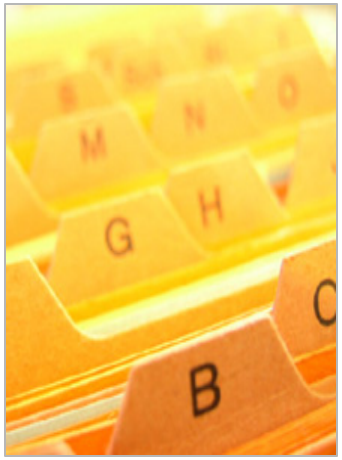

Slovak Archive of Social Data

- SASD is a joint venture of Institute for Sociology of SAS and Department of Sociology at CU
- Organization is relatively weak as a result of lack of funding possibilities
- Aims of SASD are:
  - collecting, preserving, disseminating of data and metadata,
  - collaboration on standardization in research and archiving
  - and research support
- Main tangible output of the archive for users is a webpage, through which data and documentation are disseminated

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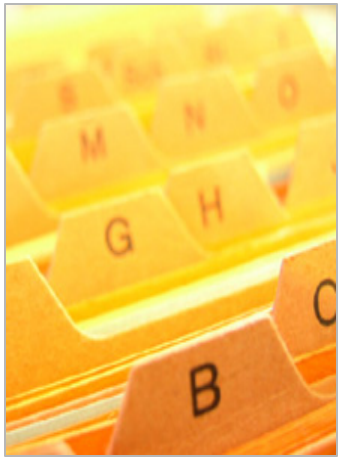

Aims of SASD

- Collecting, preserving, disseminating of quantitative micro data and metadata
  - Focus is mainly on international research programmes (EVS, ISSP,…)
  - Also national surveys
  - Open to all kind of quantitative data
- Collaboration on standardisation
  - push researchers to provide raw data with documentation and to comply with usual standards in research design (sample, data collection,…)
  - harmonisation of concepts, questions, response values/scales for enhancing comparability (internationally and over-time)

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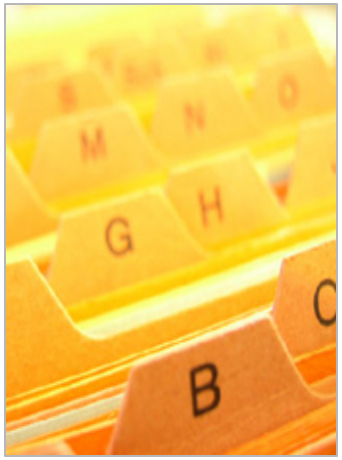

Aims of SASD

- Research support
  - facilitate secondary data usage for research
  - provide opportunity to design surveys comparable with already existing data (search existing questions, see how they were formulated and translated)
  - support unified translation of questions and their value schemes/scales, so that consequent waves of repetitive studies have identical translation, and same concepts are questioned in the same way when occurring in different studies
  - production of harmonised categories in main demographics (age cohort, education, size of municipality)

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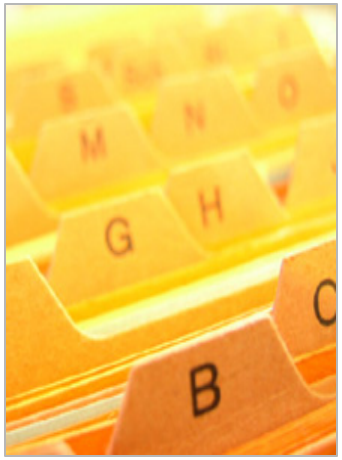
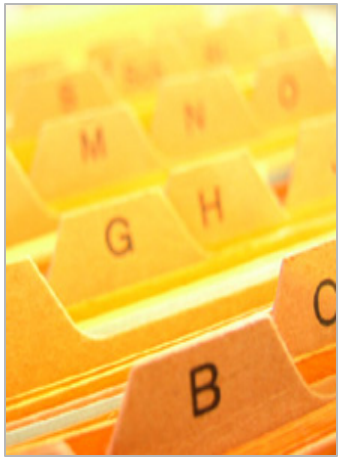


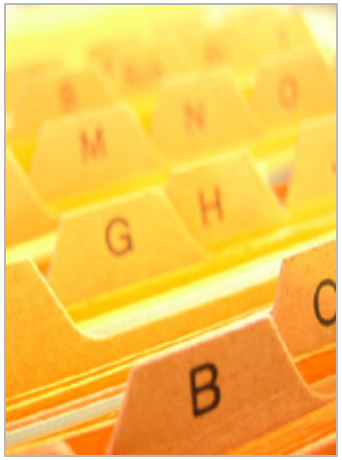
SASD website 1

- Principles:
  - simplicity
  - user friendly interface – orientation on users without deep IT knowledge
  - bilingualism – all documentation, as well as the whole website is available in Slovak and English
- DDI specification, presently version 1 / 2 (tested at Wisdom)
- Own user-oriented interface – we don't use Nesstar
  - Nesstar is a little complicated, needs time for user to gain orientation in the interface
  - is commercial and therefore not affordable by SASD



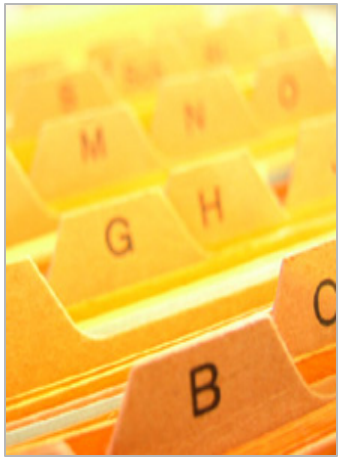
SASD website 2

- work with documentation is principal part of website, contrary to Nesstar, which is oriented on data analysis
- therefore the interface allows more clear and easy orientation for firstcomers
- website offers two alternatives of finding a particular study or information, depending on the user's needs
  - Study catalogue, sorted by year of fieldwork
  - Searching tool with possibility of "advanced search" which covers all parts of DDI documentation
  - www.sasd.sav.sk



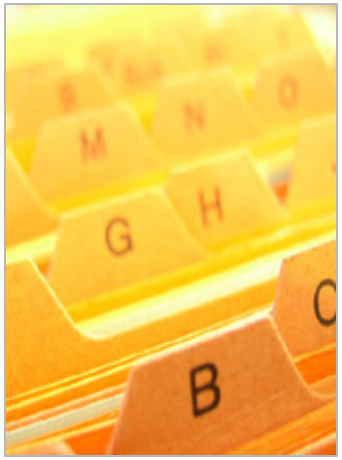
SASD website 3

- after opening of page of particular survey, following information and possibilities show up:
  - basic information, the most relevant information about study (sample, date of collection, abstract, etc.)
  - links to questionnaires in Slovak, English and Hungarian (if used) language
  - link to list of variables, where literal questions, response values, and summary statistics can be found
  - link to complete DDI documentation in XML
  - download link, where folder with datasets (SPSS) and questionnaires in both Slovak and English is available



DDI 1? 2? 3? .?

- presently using DDI 1/2
  - Notepad, NSD XML generator
- would like to take advantage of DDI 3 for reusage of various archived elements, grouping of studies mostly by institutional background (ISSP, EVS, …)
- attempt to implement DDI 3 (by now unsuccessful)
  - no possibility to develop own tools
  - specific need of importing SPSS files
  - relatively difficult for not an IT person to understand the DDI Schema without deep knowledge of magic words like XML, xsd, etc.



(International) cooperation

- DDI 3 is more standardized than previous versions
  - Schemes
  - Name tags
  - Content
- Central vs. Bilateral relations
- Suggestion: “wiki” dedicated to users of DDI, where they can share experience and communicate in structured way, which would be easy to orient in
  - also above mentioned cooperation can be managed via this wiki (or sthg. else) by individual organisations without central agent

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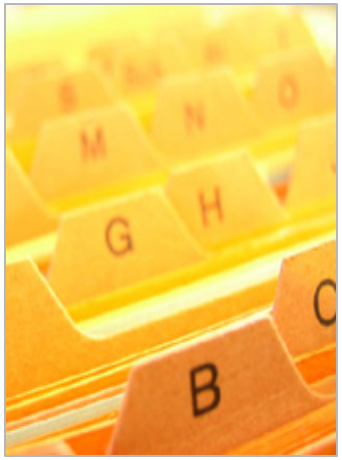

Thank you

- Questions?…